

## Final Project Instructions and Evaluation Rubric

### Assignment Overview

For your final project, you will complete a final report that demonstrates your ability to apply course concepts to a socially relevant transportation issue in the city of Chicago. The report will be due at the end of the quarter, and students will submit a draft proposal during Week 7 for instructor feedback.

Your report should adopt either an analytical or prescriptive approach and address one or more dimensions of sustainability—economic, environmental, or social. The final report should be approximately 5 double-spaced pages (about 1,250 words), formatted in 12-point Times New Roman with 0.5-inch margins. Include the following sections:

**Introduction:** Clearly state your topic and objectives.

**Background (Literature Review):** Summarize and synthesize existing research, plans, or policies that define your issue. Explain how this issue compromises sustainable transportation and discuss its economic, environmental, and social dimensions.

**Methods / Proposal:** Describe your framework or approach for understanding or addressing the issue. Explain how your solution or analysis can contribute value to the Chicago transportation community.

**Discussion and Conclusion:** Interpret your findings, propose recommendations, and highlight implications for policy or practice.

**Bibliography:** Include at least five professional or scholarly sources formatted in the Chicago Manual of Style or other standard format.

In addition, include *at least two original figures* (maps, system diagrams, design concepts, or other visuals) that effectively communicate complex information relevant to your topic.

### Citation Examples (Chicago Manual of Style)

- Book: Townsend, Anthony M. Smart Cities: Big Data, Civic Hackers, and the Quest for a New Utopia. New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 2013.
- Journal Article: Litman, Todd. "Evaluating Transportation Equity: Guidance for Incorporating Distributional Impacts in Transportation Planning." Journal of Transport Geography 12, no. 1 (2019): 1–9.
- Report: City of Chicago Department of Transportation. Strategic Plan for Transportation: 2021–2026. Chicago: CDOT, 2021.
- Website: Metropolitan Planning Council. "Equitable Transit-Oriented Development." Accessed October 17, 2025. <https://www.metroplanning.org/>.

### Evaluation Rubric

| Criteria                                  | Excellent (A)                                                                                    | Proficient (B-C)                                                             | Needs Improvement (D-F)                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Topic and Focus (2 points)                | Clearly defined, relevant, and well-structured topic addressing a critical sustainability issue. | Topic is adequate but may lack precision or clear linkage to sustainability. | Topic is vague, unfocused, or unrelated to sustainability. |
| Background / Literature Review (3 points) | Comprehensive synthesis of scholarly and professional sources with clear relevance to the issue. | Some relevant sources but limited synthesis or context.                      | Insufficient sources or weak understanding of context.     |
| Methods / Proposal (5 points)             | Innovative, rigorous, and contextually grounded framework or solution.                           | Sound but somewhat generic or underdeveloped approach.                       | Unclear, incomplete, or inappropriate methodology.         |
| Figures and Visuals (5 points)            | Two or more clear, original figures that enhance understanding.                                  | Figures included but limited originality or relevance.                       | Few or no meaningful figures.                              |
| Discussion and Conclusions (3 points)     | Insightful interpretation and recommendations with strong implications for practice or policy.   | Some interpretation or recommendations but lacking depth or clarity.         | Minimal discussion or unsupported conclusions.             |
| Writing Quality and Formatting (2 points) | Well-organized, clearly written, and properly formatted in Chicago style.                        | Readable but contains organizational or formatting inconsistencies.          | Poorly written or improperly formatted.                    |